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The Russo-German War and Indian Struggle

Report of an interview

Berlin, July 1941

[Netaji was in Rome when the Russo German War broke out He immediately communicated his reactions to this major turn in world affairs vis a-vis the Indian Struggle for independence to the German Foreign Office. On his return to Berlin, he had a discussion with Herr Woermann, a Secretary of State at the German Foreign Office The following is a translation of the report submitted by Herr Woermann to the German Government on his interview with Netaji —Ed]

Berlin, the 17th July, 1941

Mr. Bose came to meet me today after his return.

I first informed him about the tasks assigned to the Secretary of State Keppler. After his visit with me, Mr. Bose called on Mr. Keppler.

Bose at first spoke at length about the reactions of the Russo-German War on public opinion in India. The Soviet Union had been popular in India, especially among the intellectuals from whom the leaders are drawn. It is believed in India that the Soviet Union is an anti-imperialist power and would therefore be India's ally against England. The Russo-German Pact of 1939 was an event of the highest significance for India. It made it possible for the intellectuals, who anyway were drawn to National Socialism, to look upon Germany and Italy as forces which would bring about the end of British rule in India in friendship with the Soviet Union, although British propaganda had succeeded in keeping alive sentiments of enmity towards the Axis powers in most parts of India. In the German-Russian War, the sympathies of the Indian